

St Columbkille's Parish Council Meeting

9th November 2015

Church Hall

Fr Pat opened with The Lord's Prayer.

Apologies

Pat McCarron

Present

Helen McArdle, Michael Dunne, Aileen Dunne, Michael McGrath, Maureen McGrath, Katie McMillan, Chris Hughes, Eileen Bonini, Bernie Hislop, Mairead Brown, Evelyn Kearney, Isobel McCormick, Hugh Kearney, Frances Watson, Irene Lochrin, Catherine Edvaldsson, Hugh Mullen, Paul McNeill, Katy Campbell, Donald Campbell, Charles Coyle, Marie Tedeschi, Fr Ghislain, Jane Haggerty, Brian Haggerty, Bob McNamara, Tom Armstrong, Patsy Beveridge, Kathy Thompson, Irene Galt, Michelle McGuire, Martin Beveridge, Fr Pat, Miriam McKernan, Ed McGuigan

We welcomed Hamish McBeth, quantity surveyor, and Guy Logan, Estates Diocese of Motherwell to help our understanding of the building project.

Ed McGuigan reported on the building project.

Phase 1 was developed initially with major flaws in the design, and issues with the previous QS. A redesign and meticulous oversight of the project saw completion of Phase 1 in January 2014 in time

and under budget. The church is wind and water tight and major rot has been averted.

Phase 2 planning commenced in August 2013. By 2015, a major budget challenge was evident. A project in St Mary's Lanark exhausted Diocesan funds, removed the possibility of a loan, and constrained us to a tighter budget. Fresh plans with a smaller piece of work were produced. Some contractors were patient and generous. Stone flooring has been purchased. The pews are refurbished. Without our savings from the second collection, the money saved on phase 1, and the Viridor grant, Phase 2 would be impossible. By June 2015, contractors had begun to withdraw and estimates were more difficult to obtain, as the building sector regenerated after the recession. Some asbestos has been newly identified, and the legal process is underway to deal with this contamination of the site. [Since the meeting this work has now been completed]

It is anticipated that the work will start to replace the floor at end November 2015, and the work is to be finished by June 2016 to fulfil the requirements of the Viridor grant.

At present, we have a shortfall of £80,000 for phase 2 work.

The patience of the parishioners during this time we are out of our church was acknowledged.

The presentation was opened to the floor.

Evelyn Kearney voiced concern about lack of evident progress with the work, and the sadness felt by people at being denied the use of the church.

Hugh Kearney requested regular updates on the work.

ACTION:

These concerns were discussed and acknowledged. It was agreed that the parish council would produce monthly reports on the building work. These will be available on the website, and in the bulletin.

Guy Logan gave background about local advancing of the project in Lanark without the oversight of the Diocese, and expensive litigation that ensued, resulting in the loss of the entire building fund of the diocese. Guy commended the building group in St Columbkille's for their careful work.

Hamish McBeth introduced himself. He is a chartered surveyor with five decades experience in church buildings, including our church hall, the visitors' centre at Carfin, and listed buildings apart from ours. He explained the niceties of working on listed buildings. He praised the work of the group in their thorough preparation for phase 1, now completed, and now phase 2. He explained that with similar projects in St Aloysius and in Luss Parish Church, the work took over ten years to complete, in stages. Our experience in St Columbkille's is similar to these other projects. Taking time and planning well, even if it takes so long, is the correct way to go.

In response to an inquiry from Hugh Kearney, Hamish outlined the scope of Phase 2. The work will encompass limestone flooring, refurbished seating, heating and painting. Funding restrictions mean that we may not produce a new baptismal font of living water. There will be piping and electricity in place in a plinth ready for the font when we can afford it. Marble reparation work will be done. Hamish's role is to prepare contract documents. He manages the contract between the contractors and the church.

Michael McGrath commended the volunteers who have worked so hard on our behalf. He asked if the grant from Viridor was assured. Guy Logan affirmed this. The purpose is for floor, heating and sanctuary.

Patsy Beveridge asked about the organ. Hamish replied that the organ has been decommissioned. Recommissioning will be a separate piece of work.

A recent piece in the Reformer was felt to be unhelpful. However, journalists do report. It was agreed we should write to the reformer with some more positive news.

ACTION:

The business of the building project was finished. Hamish and Guy were thanked and they left. Ed was thanked, and he resumed his place in the meeting.

Marriage and baptism preparation

Preparation for the sacraments is to be rolled out and shared across the Deanery. Further plans will emerge after the Deanery meeting on 10th November. Deacon Bill was commended for his work with the parents of infants presented for baptism. It is likely that lay people will be doing this work in future, to fulfil their role as envisaged in Vatican 2, the priest and people working together.

Mass times in the Deanery

This will be discussed to provide Masses across the Deanery to suit all groups within the area. Christmas and vigil Mass times will be included. Concerns were expressed about large numbers within the church hall, and the unsuitability of evening mass for the older people.

The Year of Mercy

Bishop Toal will meet the Council of Priests to discuss diocese business, including the year of mercy commencing advent 2015.

Eucharistic Ministry

Bob McNamara reported on the increase in numbers of the Eucharistic Ministers. He thanked Frances Watson for her good work in ensuring the protection of children and vulnerable groups throughout the parish. Fr Liam Connor gave a retreat in June around ministry to the sick, drawing on his work as chaplain in Hairmyres Hospital. Fr Ghislain contributed additional areas for reflection.

There are 33 ministers visiting 105 persons.

A retreat held in September at the Comboni Fathers attracted 16 Ministers for prayer, reflection on scripture, and Mass.

The next quarterly meeting takes place in December. All the sick will receive a Christmas card from the parish.

Martin asked about communion under both kinds. There were challenges around Ministers not turning up said Fr Pat. Even so, there was a strong wish expressed for communion under both species, perhaps one Mass per Sunday, perhaps on very special days such as Holy Thursday. It was suggested that weekday Mass, well attended and well supplied with ministers, might be a starting point. Fr Pat has two co-pilots (Fr Ghislain and Fr Stephen Reilly) and will discuss with them.

ACTION:

Would readers and Eucharistic ministers please attend at the sacristy ten minutes before Mass and make known to the celebrant their presence and role.

Rotas could possibly be placed on the website.

Charismatic prayer group

Kathy Thompson reported that the group meets on Wednesdays. They are focussing in on the Gospel of Mark.

Legion of Mary

Marie Tedeschi reported that the work of the Legion continues. The Legion assisted the primary school in the Rosary during October. They update sick lists and visit the sick at home and in hospital.

Altar servers

Michelle McGuire reported on several new members. They meet on the first Monday of every month. They are very keen.

RCIA

Chris Hughes reported on the five adults who were received into the Church last year. There are two young men at present in the programme. They have young children and they are very enthusiastic. They will be presented to the parish on the first Sunday of Advent. There is also one young woman who is a Catholic, and who attends to renew her faith after some time away.

PVG

Frances reported that all persons had been processed by PVG Scotland by 31st October. She is now a verifier for PVG, which streamlines the application. She is newly appointed as PVG responsible person for the Diocese of Motherwell.

We discussed including safeguarding, and it was agreed to include the Diocese's position on safeguarding on the website.

ACTION:

Hall

Donald Campbell reported that the hall is functioning under capacity at present. We are short of volunteers. After some functions, the volunteer staff may be working until 2am. More people please. The hall raises revenue for the parish, but it relies heavily on volunteers in the bar and restoring the furniture after functions for Mass.

Catherine Edvaldsson thanked Donald and his family and suggested a volunteer list.

ACTION: MIRIAM

UCM

Evelyn K reported on the twice monthly meetings of the UCM. There are 15 members. They attended a retreat in the Comboni Fathers. They attended the Diocesan vocations Mass.

Craft group

Evelyn K reported on the fellowship, friendship and fundraising of the craft group. They are working on a school for the deaf for Sr Anne McAllister in Kenya.

Fund raising committee

St Francis Pipe Band played a concert and raised £1500 on November 5th. There will be a race night at the end of January.

Colum

Katie McMillan requested permission to set up a Facebook page for the parish. It was agreed this

was a useful way to engage some younger people, and link to the parish website.

ACTION:

There are Colum CDs whose sale will support the building project. Katie proposed a raffle, selling CDs at £5.00 each, with a raffle included. Catherine Edvaldsson offered to help with sale of CDs.

Colum annual concert will take place on March 5th in the Hall to support the building project.

Passkeepers

Hugh Kearney reported no problems in this area.

Small Group Faith Sharing

Michael Dunne reported on the continuing work of two small faith sharing groups in the parish. Michael will make a page on the groups for inclusion on the website

ACTION MICHAEL:

Stall

Mairead reported on steady profit made by the stall. Christmas stock has gone well, and a fresh order has been made.

Our meeting closed as Fr Pat reminded us that many people are working for the good of the parish. We ended with prayer.

Minutes Irene Galt

Report prepared by Miriam McKernan 20151121